

UMA STRATEGY GROUP INTERVIEW - SPRING 2026

THE CASE: Liquid Death

Background:

Liquid Death, a canned water company with the slogan “Murder Your Thirst”, has disrupted the \$20B bottled water industry with its can’s unique design and marketing. By packaging water in tallboy recyclable cans that resemble craft beer and employing dark, satirical humor, the brand has captured a demographic that typically finds traditional water brands, such as Dasani or Fiji, boring. Their brand identity is built on sustainability and an unfiltered personality that resonates with Gen Z's distaste for traditional advertising.

The Challenge:

Liquid Death aims to move beyond viral novelty to become the largest hydration brand on college campuses. However, they face competition from traditional giants (PepsiCo/Coca-Cola) who hold long-term exclusive rights at many universities, as well as traditional water competitors. Your task is to develop a strategy that bypasses traditional corporate barriers to make Liquid Death integral to the social scene of campus culture, focusing on social events, sustainability, and peer-to-peer influence.

Your task is to propose **innovative strategies** that:

1. Increase Liquid Death’s long-term engagement and relevance among college students.
2. Leverage Gen Z's preferences for community-building, personalization, and user-generated content.
3. Highlight the unique value Liquid Death can bring to college life, both on and off campus.

Ensure your ideas are creative, practical, and tailored to Gen Z's unique habits and desires.

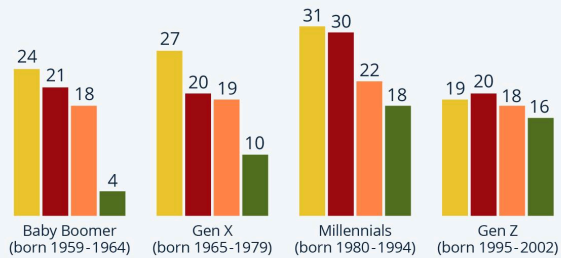
Questions:

1. Estimate the annual market size for single-serve water, across any different packaging type, consumed by students at U.S. colleges and universities. Consider different consumption occasions, such as dining halls, studying, athletics, and social events, and how students' purchasing behavior might differ across each.
2. What are the common trends among Gen Z students, and how can Liquid Death utilize this for a campaign? (Please refer to the charts provided)
3. What challenges and opportunities do you foresee if Liquid Death attempts to expand in this way on college campuses?
4. The CEO of Liquid Death asked you for a final summary of your team’s findings and observations. Provide an overall recommendation and summarize what you've just discussed.

Gen Z: The More Sober Generation

Share of respondents who regularly consume the following types of alcohol, by generation (in percent)

■ Beer ■ Wine ■ Spirits ■ Hard seltzer



10,000 U.S. respondents (18-64 y/o) surveyed Jul. 2022-Jun. 2023.

Questions only shown to respondents of legal drinking age

Quelle: Statista Consumer Insights

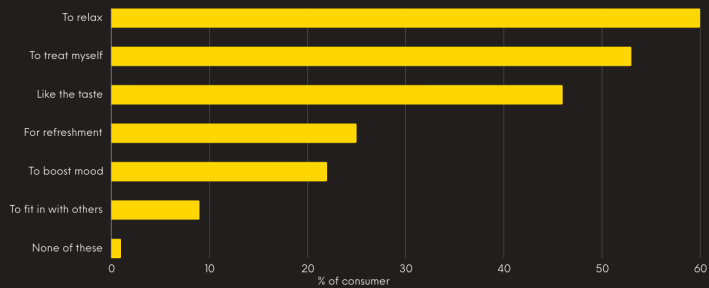


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MINTEL

UK: Reasons for drinking alcohol, 2023

Wanting to relax is the leading reason for drinking alcohol, cited by 60% of drinkers.



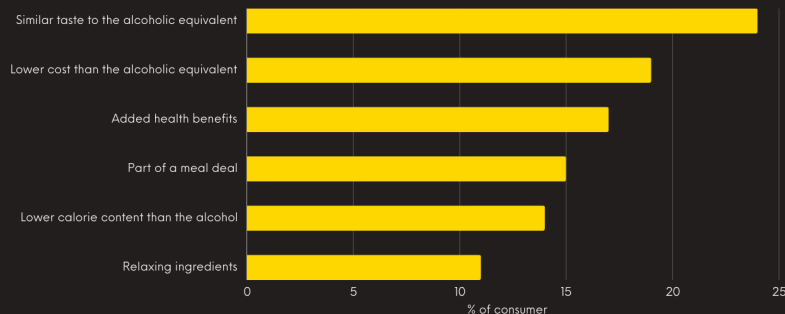
Base: 1,634 internet users aged 18+ who have drunk alcohol either in or out of the home in the last 3 months

Source: Mintel's Alcoholic Drinks Review UK, 2023

MINTEL

Enticements to buy non-alcoholic/alcohol-free drinks, 2023

A similar taste to the alcoholic equivalent is the leading enticement for non-alcoholic/alcohol-free drinks, cited by 24% of adults



Base: 1,969 internet users aged 18+

Source: Mintel's Attitudes towards Low and No-Alcohol Drinks UK, 2023